



1. Every room in the Capella has a view of the Chao Phraya River
2. The airy, sun-kissed lobby
3. The verandah suite



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LAST WEEK, I stayed at the Best Hotel in the World. No, really. Not just some overhyped marketing claim or a TripAdvisor review written by someone who thinks a fruit basket and free Wi-Fi define luxury. This was official. Capella Bangkok had just been crowned ‘World’s Best Hotel’ at the prestigious World’s 50 Best Hotels Awards, a title handed down by an anonymous panel of well-travelled voters in search of the ultimate place to lay their jet-lagged heads.

Naturally, I had to see if it truly deserved the crown.

Despite its newly minted title, Capella isn’t exactly a household name, at least not in India. It’s not a Marriott or Four Seasons, yet it has outshined the biggest names in global hospitality to claim the No.1 spot.

Owned by a billionaire Singaporean real estate tycoon with just a handful of properties worldwide, it has built its reputation on hyper-personalised service and caters to those who never need to glance at the price tag.